

EARTH



Imagine you are an astronaut looking at Earth from your spacecraft. What you see is a big blue ball covered with swirling clouds that hide features such as continents and mountains. The ball looks so blue because more than two-thirds of it is covered with water in the form of oceans, seas, lakes and rivers.

The surface of Earth, called the crust, moves all the time, but this movement is so slow that we are not aware of it. Eventually, however, pressure builds up and causes earthquakes. Changes also happen when the crust is worn away by water or huge blocks of moving ice called glaciers, or when volcanoes erupt.

Our planet can support life only because it gets light and heat from the sun. Without it, the Earth would be a cold, dark and dead place.

The Himalaya mountains in Nepal look very different from far out in space.

